

Steve Helinski

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Portfolio of Work: <https://helinsm.github.io/>

SUMMARY

Technical writer with 5+ years of experience producing IT and software documentation, procedures, and training materials using topic-based authoring, single-sourcing, and structured authoring standards. Comfortable working in agile and scrum environments with engineers, product owners, and SMEs.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director of Operations | Greenhouse Winery

Nov 2025 – Present

Part owner of the business until its 2025 sale. Retained by the new owners to run operations.

- Managed supply chain, inventory, and operations across four locations and a catalog of 30+ wine varieties.
- Wrote SOPs, work instructions, and operational guides covering topics such as day-to-day procedures, winemaking protocols, event hosting guidelines, wholesale processes, and more.
- Maintained the company website and produced marketing materials including event graphics, social posts, and customer-facing copy.
- Coordinated procedures between owners, managers, production team, and part-time employees.

Technical Writer | ADP

Jan 2022 – Nov 2025

- Standardized unstructured notes, guides, and procedures into a unified knowledge base for HCM and payroll software, organizing process documentation across 6+ business units.
- Authored 100+ knowledge base articles from scratch and refactored dozens more into DITA using Ixiasoft CMS on Oxygen XML Editor, applying topic-based authoring and task-oriented design.
- Collaborated with a team of 9 writers to identify content reuse opportunities and improve consistency across a dozen-plus product lines.
- Worked with product owners, developers, and SMEs through a comment-based review workflow on drafts, incorporating feedback to validate technical accuracy.
- Reviewed and edited peer documentation for format, style, voice, and clarity.
- Applied minimalism principles to eliminate redundant and repeated content and correct inconsistent formatting across the knowledge base.

Associate Technical Writer | University of Pittsburgh Medical Center (UPMC)

Mar 2021 – Jan 2022

- Documented software changes on an agile team supporting an application that managed patient health records.
- Wrote and maintained user manuals, release notes, what's new guides, and known issues content for each quarterly software release.
- Served as point person on 2 releases by coordinating deliverables across a team of 6 writers.
- Used MadCap Flare for single-source publishing in a multi-author environment.
- Participated in stand-ups, sprint planning, and retros. Tracked work in Azure DevOps and wrote from user stories and SME input.

Technical Writer Intern | Optimus Technologies

Jun 2020 – Sep 2020

- Wrote a 50-page product manual for a biodiesel fuel system, working with engineers and SMEs to document specifications and system instructions.
- Produced marketing materials, whitepapers, and other informational content about the system and company.

Technical Writer Research Assistant | Carnegie Mellon University

Apr 2020 – Sep 2020

- Using DITA principles, generated end-user documentation for a computer-assisted rhetorical analysis tool.
- Formatted and edited user guides with Adobe InDesign and Oxygen XML Editor.
- Developed video tutorials to supplement instructional materials.

EDUCATION

Master of Arts in Professional Writing | Carnegie Mellon University

Dec 2020

Bachelor of Arts in English | Duquesne University

Dec 2013

SKILLS

Structured Authoring: DITA, XML, Ixiasoft CMS, Oxygen XML, MadCap Flare, topic-based authoring, single-sourcing, minimalism, task-oriented design, information architecture

Documentation Types: User manuals, work instructions, online help, release notes, SOPs, policies and procedures, quality forms, training guides, knowledge base articles, editing and QA

Process & Tools: Agile/Scrum (Azure DevOps), version control (GitHub), SME interviewing, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel), SharePoint, Google Drive, Adobe Acrobat, Adobe Creative Cloud (InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop), Microsoft Visio, Snagit; familiar with HTML, CSS, Python